

JOSEPH POINTER

AI Adoption & Enablement Leader, Operating Models That Scale, Learning-Technology Roots

Three-time TIAA Values Champion (2022, 2025, 2026) and a Fall 2025 "Face of TIAA," one of four individuals recognized that month

Denver Metro Area | 303-888-3151 | joe@joepointer.com

linkedin.com/in/josephpointer | joepointer.com/?company=instructure (built for Instructure)

1,500+

ASSOCIATES I REACHED
DIRECTLY ACROSS 30+
ENABLEMENT EVENTS

16,000+

IN THE COMPANY-WIDE
ROLLOUT OF THE AI PLATFORM I
CONCEIVED AND LAUNCHED

7

BUSINESS AREAS ON ONE
OPERATING FRAMEWORK

2

INDEPENDENT AI PRODUCTS,
LIVE IN PRODUCTION

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

I am technically fluent enough to scope a problem, tell a good technical answer from a bad one, and direct a build to the finish. I am not the engineer. The AI products I have shipped are the proof I do not need to be.

I close the gap between AI investment and real change in how people work, and I build the operating model that makes it repeatable. At TIAA (Fortune 100 retirement services, \$1.5T AUM) I conceived and launched a 9-module AI-powered career development platform rolled out company-wide to 16,000+ associates, and I owned it from the first discovery conversation through governance, deployment, and measured use. I connected seven business areas under one shared approach, central expertise in one place and execution owned by each area. My M.S. in Instructional Technology grounds the enablement work in behavior change, not content produced, so a capability shows up at the moment someone needs it in real work. Before TIAA, ten years at Pearson and Vangent building enterprise learning and hiring platforms for Fortune 500 clients, sitting between the client's problem and the team that shipped what they bought.

INDEPENDENT AI PRODUCTS CONCEIVED AND SHIPPED

The reason I can sit with an engineering team, judge the trade-offs, and keep a decision moving without pretending to be the engineer.

- **Future Me, Answered (futuremeanswered.com), live in production:** I conceived this AI career-discovery product for students, designed the 5-stage discovery framework, and modeled the career data across 922 paths. I directed the build on Next.js, the Vercel AI SDK, and multi-provider AI, and specified a FERPA-aligned architecture with role-scoped access for students, counselors, parents, and administrators. My brother engineered the production backend. I own the product decisions.
- **CareerPointers (careerpointers.org), live:** I conceived an 11-module career development platform and designed its journey, including a multi-agent AI interview simulator that reads a job description, simulates panel dynamics across 8 presets and pressure levels, and returns scored coaching reports, an applicant CRM, and the employer-personalized portfolio delivery this resume's link runs on. I directed the build on Next.js and Stripe and write production code by directing AI tooling. My brother is the co-founder and primary engineer.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director, Business Management

February 2022 - July 2026

TIAA (Fortune 100 Retirement Services, \$1.5T AUM)

Business Manager (August 2016 - February 2022) | Sr. Management Specialist (June 2013 - August 2016) | Business Consultant (May 2011 - June 2013)

Led the associate-transformation workstream of TIAA's Recordkeeping Transformation program. Led enterprise initiatives across the Client Services organization (~3,000 associates), partnering across HR, Technology, Workplace Services, Risk, Compliance, and Legal.

Operating Model and AI Adoption at Scale

- **Built one operating framework across seven business areas so good work scaled instead of being rebuilt:** Connected seven Client Services business areas through named liaisons, one shared strategy, and peer learning across Workplace, Associate Engagement, and Rewards and Recognition. Central expertise in one place, execution owned by each area. One approach run seven times, in place of seven approaches.
- **Took an AI platform from idea to company-wide launch and measured use (2024 - 2025):** Conceived, designed, and launched a 9-module AI-powered career development platform, built for the Recordkeeping Transformation population and then rolled out company-wide. Owned every stage, from discovery and use-case scoping through governance, deployment, adoption strategy, and impact measurement.
- **Measured adoption by active usage, not headcount with access:** Reached 1,500+ associates directly, going after people who were not looking, and reported active usage to senior leaders rather than the access count. Access is the easy number; usage tells a leader whether the investment worked.

Governance, Enablement, and Change

- **Cleared Risk, Compliance, and Legal without stalling the build:** Prototyped and pressure-tested the idea first, then brought Risk, Compliance, and Legal in to set the hard limits once it was worth building. No associate data on company servers. No AI-initiated actions. Guided prompts that keep the person in control of the decision. The guardrails were what let it ship, not what held it back.
- **Built and ran an enablement curriculum with a team of 7:** Designed 5 tracks of 12 to 17 modules each on future and digital-first skills, mapped to real role trajectories, and delivered to the associates impacted by the Recordkeeping Transformation. 890 associates engaged across 1,156 interactions. The tracks were built around how people learn and apply, not just what to cover.
- **Led workplace modernization for 3,000+ associates across six locations (2022 - 2024):** Owned change strategy through return-to-office and a major multi-site consolidation. Recognized as Change Champion.

Sales Engineer, Information Architect, and Instructional Designer

January 2001 - March 2011

Interactive Media / FT Knowledge / Pearson Performance Solutions

/ Vangent Human Capital

Continuous tenure through a chain of acquisitions from a learning-technology startup into Pearson, then Vangent. Enterprise and workforce learning technology for Fortune 500 clients and federal agencies.

- **Designed enterprise learning architecture deployed across five Fortune 500 companies (Revolver LCMS):** A knowledge architecture that separated core content from contextual delivery, single-source publishing two decades before it was common.
- **Sat between the client's problem and the team that had to build it, for ten years:** Worked directly with Fortune 500 clients (Unilever, Bank of America, Verizon Wireless) to scope capability needs, design adoption approaches, and shape multi-year implementation roadmaps across business and technical audiences.
- **Carried the technical answer into the room without being the developer:** Led enterprise ATS implementations, including the Department of Commerce (2010 Census hiring) and Extra Space Storage. Field-driven enhancements cut client hiring costs 50-80% and speed-to-hire in half.

LEADERSHIP CAPABILITIES

AI & Enablement: AI Adoption Strategy | Use-Case Discovery & Prioritization | Role-Based Enablement & Capability Building | Agentic AI & Multi-Agent Workflows | Daily builder across Claude, Claude Code, ChatGPT, Gemini, GitHub Copilot

Governance & Production AI (direction, not administration): Responsible AI Governance | Risk, Compliance & Legal Partnership | Data-Handling, Access, and Guardrail Requirements | Approved-Model and Integration Standards | Directing Engineers and Technical Builds

Learning & EdTech: Instructional Design | Behavior-Change Enablement | Learning Content Management (LCMS) | Curriculum & Capability Strategy | Adoption & Impact Measurement

Operating Model & Executive: AI Center of Excellence Operating Model (Centralized Expertise, Decentralized Execution) | Operating Framework Design | Business Case Development | Cross-Functional Influence

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

M.S. Instructional Technology, Bloomsburg University, PA (4.0 GPA) | **B.A. Art**, Millersville University, PA

Certifications: Google Generative AI for Leaders | Lean for Financial Services, TIAA